people.'!

We must assume then that these momentous inventions were not just due to the momentary illumination of an erratic genius, much in advance of his time, but that they were essentialy the product of the social *milieu* and that they answered some insistent demand of the times. Genius of a high order was certainly

**Quoted in L. Hogben's 'Mathematics for the Million',* (*London, 1942).*

tHogben: 'Mathematics for the Million', (London, 1942), p. 285.

necessary to find this out and fulfil the demand, but if the demand had not been there the urge to find some way out would have been absent, and even if the invention had been made it would have been foi gotten or put aside till circumstances more propitious for its use arose. It seems clear from the early Sanskrit works on mathematics that the demand was there, for these books are full of problems of trade and social relationship involving complicated calculations. There are problems dealing with taxation, debt, and interest; problems of partnership, barter and exchange, and the calculation of the fineness of gold. Society had grown complex and laige numbers of people were engaged in govern-